



MUMBAI BLASTS, JULY 11, 2006

State intelligence wings, seen as dumping grounds for police officials, need a status overhaul if detection and prevention have to be improved

Agency Coordination Centre (MAAC) two years ago, India's alphabet soup of Central intelligence agencies—the IB, the National Technical Research Organisation (NTRO), the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence, the Research and Analysis Wing (R&AW), the Border Security Force (BSF) and Military Intelligence—have been sharing intelligence with one another. This is a critical process because except the last two, the others are pure intelligence gatherers and if the information they have is to be put to use, it has to be shared instantly with the army, the police and BSF. Little has happened since then. One intelligence official calls MAAC a tea-and-

biscuits forum because the agencies are still loath to share intelligence. "There is lack of accountability so far as intelligence agencies are concerned," says General V.P. Malik, former chief of the army staff.

MORE BOOTS ON THE GROUND

While officials reckon that anti-terror technology works only up to a certain level, the most crucial element in combating insidious terror modules is human intelligence. "The police